USER MANUAL · REV 1.0

MIDI FILTER

Compact MIDI Message Filter · handmade in Austria by Walter Craffonara

1 Overview & Concept

The CRAFFONARA FX MIDI Filter is a very compact utility — just 5 × 5 × 3 cm — that sits on your board and removes unwanted MIDI messages before they reach the rest of your rig. It is not an effect pedal, but a problem-solver for MIDI-heavy setups where stray messages (a flood of MIDI Clock, constant Active Sensing chatter or a controller's SysEx dumps) can cause dropouts, timing glitches or unwanted parameter changes.

Filtering is set with eight DIP switches, one per message type. The logic is the same for every switch: OFF lets the message pass through untouched, ON filters it out. The device then provides separate unfiltered, filtered and switchable outputs, so you can route both streams wherever you need them at the same time.

2 Controls & Connections

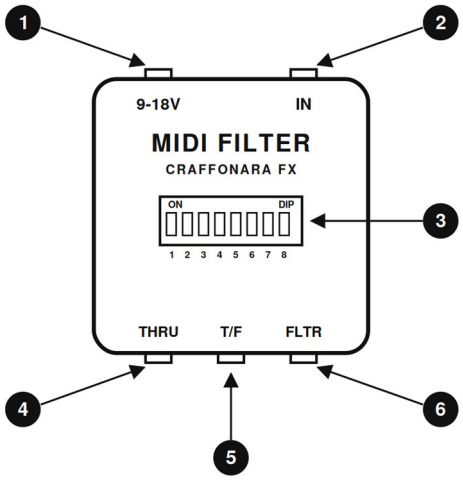


Fig. 1 — Panel and connections

1 POWER (9–18 V DC) center-negative supply input. Run it anywhere from 9 to 18 V from your regulated pedalboard supply.

2 MIDI IN TRS (Type A) MIDI input — feed in the MIDI signal you want to filter.

3 DIP SWITCHES 1–8 the filter matrix. OFF passes a message type, ON filters it out. See section 3.

4 THRU TRS output carrying the incoming MIDI unchanged — always unfiltered, regardless of the DIP settings.

5 T/F TRS output whose content is chosen by DIP 8: either THRU (unfiltered) or the filtered signal.

6 FLTR TRS output carrying the filtered MIDI — always filtered, as configured by DIP 1–7.

3 The DIP Switches

Set a switch to ON to filter (remove) that message type; leave it OFF to let it pass through.

DIP	Filters (when ON)	Notes
1	SysEx messages	System-exclusive data such as patch dumps and device-specific data
2	System Common	Song Position Pointer, Song Select, Tune Request, etc.
3	MIDI Clock	Real-time timing / clock bytes
4	— (reserved)	Reserved — must stay OFF
5	Program Change	Program Change messages
6	Start / Stop / Continue	Transport real-time messages
7	Active Sensing	Keep-alive “heartbeat” chatter
8	T/F Output Mode	OFF = T/F carries THRU (unfiltered); ON = T/F carries filtered MIDI

NOTE DIP 4 is reserved and must remain OFF for correct operation. DIP 8 does not filter a message type — it selects what the T/F jack outputs.

4 Outputs & Signal Routing

Three outputs run at the same time, so you can use the filtered and unfiltered streams in parallel:

THRU — always the untouched input signal. Chain a full MIDI feed on to another device while the filter cleans a separate path.

FLTR — always the filtered signal, shaped by DIP 1–7. Send this to the device you want to protect from unwanted messages.

T/F — a flexible fourth jack. With DIP 8 OFF it mirrors THRU (unfiltered); with DIP 8 ON it mirrors FLTR (filtered) — handy when you need two copies of one or the other.

Example: to stop a sequencer’s MIDI Clock and Active Sensing from reaching a synth while still passing Program Changes, set DIP 3 (Clock) and DIP 7 (Active Sensing) to ON, leave DIP 5 (Program Change) OFF, and take the synth’s feed from the FLTR output.

5 Power

The MIDI Filter runs on 9–18 V DC, center-negative — the same standard as the CRAFFONARA FX pedals, so it shares any regulated pedalboard supply. There is no battery compartment; power it from your board.

6 Specifications

Parameter	Value
Function	MIDI message filter, 8-way DIP configurable
Filtered types	SysEx, System Common, MIDI Clock, Program Change, Start/Stop/Continue, Active Sensing
MIDI I/O	IN, THRU (unfiltered), FLTR (filtered), T/F (switchable) — TRS (Type A)
Outputs	3 simultaneous (THRU + FLTR + T/F)
Power	9–18 V DC, center-negative
Dimensions	approx. 5 × 5 × 3 cm

Parameter	Value
Enclosure	Brushed aluminium

> **NOTE** MIDI is a registered trademark of the MIDI Manufacturers Association. This product is an independent build and is not affiliated with or endorsed by any third party.